

Scientist Network for Advancing Policy (SNAP)

snapcoalition.org/
Policy Hackathon 2026

Policy <> Track H Workforce & Labor Policy

About This Track:

This challenge is part of the Policy Hackathon 2026 H track: Workforce / Labor. Design a policy response to a live labor-market disruption for a specific industry or region.

Use Case Description:

This challenge asks teams to design a policy response to a live labor-market disruption — automation/AI displacement, skills gaps, or job-quality issues — for a specific industry or region.

Problem Statement:

Responding to automation, skills gaps, or job-quality disruption in the labor market.

- Select a focus: AI/automation workforce transition, apprenticeship & vocational training expansion, gig-economy worker classification, unemployment insurance modernization, or occupational licensing reform.
- Ground the problem in labor-market data (employment, wage, displacement trends).
- Review existing policy levers (UI, WIOA funding, licensing law, labor law).
- Design a policy proposal with an implementation and funding plan.
- Identify which workers/regions are most exposed and how the policy addresses that.

Possible Approaches:

- Retraining — design or expand a reskilling/apprenticeship pipeline funded through workforce boards.
- Safety-net — modernize unemployment insurance or wage insurance for displaced workers.
- Regulatory — reform occupational licensing or gig-worker classification rules.
- Employer-incentive — design tax or subsidy incentives for job creation/retention.

Challenge Duration:

- Teams start working in September 2026
- Submission on **November 14, 2026**. There will be no extension to the submission deadline.

Team Guidelines:

- Team size — **3–5 participants per team, interdisciplinary encouraged.**
- Ensure you are enrolled as a participant in Policy Hackathon 2026.
- Everyone is eligible to participate in this challenge and win awards.
- Standout teams may be invited to brief partner organizations or judges directly on their proposal.

Challenge Tasks / Deliverables:

- 4–6 page policy brief with labor-market data and recommendation
- One-page fact sheet for a workforce board or state legislature audience

- Slide deck (8–10 slides)
- An implementation timeline showing funding sources and milestones
- Process appendix (0.5 page)

Optional Advanced Tasks:

- Interview a displaced worker, employer, or workforce-board staffer (with consent)
- Build a simple “who's exposed” map by industry/region
- Cost-per-job-saved or cost-per-worker-retrained analysis
- A dissenting-view memo from an employer or union perspective

Platforms and Tools:

- Data: BLS, O*NET, state workforce agency dashboards, Census Bureau
- Legislative tracking: Congress.gov, state legislature sites
- Drafting/collaboration: Google Docs, shared repo

Judging Criteria:

- Data-driven problem definition — **25%**
- Feasibility (political + fiscal) — **20%**
- Equity across affected workers/regions — **20%**
- Clarity of implementation plan — **20%**
- Presentation quality — **15%**

Data Privacy / Eligibility Restriction:

- Use only public, aggregate labor data — no individually identifiable worker records.
- Consent and anonymization for any worker interviews unless attribution is agreed.
- Disclose AI tool use.

Participants retain ownership of their submissions but grant Scientist Network for Advancing Policy (SNAP) the right to evaluate, discuss, and showcase submitted work for educational and research purposes, with appropriate attribution.